

A blue-tinted background image showing a hand holding a smartwatch. The watch screen displays '101', 'FACTORY RHYTHM', 'TEAM', and '0:00:00'. A yellow star icon is positioned above the hand.

# The Player-Coach Playbook

M.V.P.  Accelerator™  
POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



#### Lesson 4

## Activate Your M.V.P. Under Pressure



“Pressure is  
a privilege - it  
only comes  
to those who  
have earned it.”

- *Billie Jean King*





#### Drill 4.1

## Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 4*

*(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.1)*



#### Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 4. A plan is just a theory until it meets reality. This week is about activating your M.V.P. when it matters most—when the pressure is on and the stakes are high. This is where leadership is truly revealed and conditioned, and where your **Resilience** and **Agility** are tested.

#### ► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Develop your personal “Resilience Playbook” consciously to manage your reactions under stress.
- » Learn to diagnose the root cause of resistance to change within your team.
- » Practice coaching for agility to help your Athleader and team pivot effectively.

# A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



## Drill 4.2

### LEAD SELF — Your Resilience Playbook

*(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.2)*



#### Instructions:

Your team's resilience is a direct reflection of your own. An emotionally regulated leader promotes psychological safety and clear thinking. This drill helps you move from being reactive to being responsive by defining your go-to plays for staying calm and focused under pressure.



#### Action

Identify 2-3 common stress triggers and design a specific “Resilience Play” for each.





My Resilience Playbook

Common Stress Trigger

(What is a recurring situation at work that causes you to feel stressed, overwhelmed, or reactive?)

My “Resilience Play”

(What is one simple, immediate action you can take to create a pause between the trigger and your reaction?)

A.R.A.W. Pillar Strengthened

(Wellbeing, Resilience, etc.)

Example

Receiving an unexpected, critical email from a senior leader.

Example

Stand up, walk to get water. Do not reply for at least 10 minutes.

Example

Well-being / Resilience

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

Drill 4.3

LEAD OTHERS — Diagnosing Resistance to Change

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.3)



Instructions:

Resistance to change is rarely about the change itself; it's about a perceived loss. Your play as a Player-Coach is to listen beyond the surface-level complaints to diagnose what your team fears they will lose. Understanding this is the key to unlocking buy-in.



Action

Think of a recent change you led (or are currently leading). Analyze the resistance to identify the primary root fear.

Change Analysis Worksheet

1

The Change Initiative

(Briefly describe the change.)



My Response



## 2 The Root Fear

*(Based on your team's questions and behaviors, what was the primary fear driving resistance? Check the most dominant one and provide your evidence below.)*

### ● Loss of Certainty

*(Fear of the unknown, ambiguity, lack of a clear plan)*

### ● Loss of Competence:

*(Fear of not being able to adapt, learn new skills, or succeed in the new environment)*

### ● Loss of Connection

*(Fear of a change to team dynamics, relationships, or informal networks)*

## Evidence / Observations

*(What did you see or hear that points to this specific fear?)*

### My Response

**Coaching Corner:** Understanding this fundamentally changes how you will lead the next change. How can you proactively address this specific fear the next time you introduce a new initiative?

## Drill 4.4

# LEAD OTHERS — The Agility Coaching Question

*(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.4)*



### Instructions:

A Player-Coach who always provides the answer creates dependency. A Player-Coach who asks powerful questions builds **Agility**. Your role is to build your Athleader's capacity to solve problems by shifting from "problem-solver-in-chief" to "question-asker."



### Action

Add the following powerful question to your coaching toolkit. The next time your Athleader brings you a problem, resist the urge to solve it and make this your first response.

## Your Go-To Agility Question

*"That's a tough challenge. What's your initial read on a path forward?"*



### Practice Plan

Identify a specific, upcoming situation or meeting where you can practice using this question this week.



### Situation / Person

## Reflection

How does asking this question first, instead of providing a solution, change the dynamic of the conversation?

 My Response

 My notes

## Locker Room Reflection

*(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 4.4)*

**Challenge & Self-Scouting:** When you are under pressure, does your team see you as a source of calm or a source of stress? What is one specific behavior you can change this week (leveraging your Resilience Playbook from Drill 4.2) to better model resilience and composure for your team?

 My Response